

Sustainability Report — University College Cork

Prepared **with reference to** the GRI Standards · compiled 2026-09-06

About this report. It is generated from University College Cork's public AASHE STARS 3.0 submission, mapped onto the GRI Standards. It covers 78 GRI disclosures across 13 standards. Where a disclosure cannot be answered from STARS data, the report says so and why, rather than omitting the question. **How the figures got here — and why they can be trusted.** Every number in this document was copied by code from the extracted STARS dataset. The language model that wrote the prose was never shown a figure: it wrote named placeholders and the values were substituted afterwards, so it could not alter, round or invent one. After substitution the finished text is scanned, and the build fails if any number in it cannot be traced back to the source data. The model chose the sentences; it did not choose the numbers. **What that guarantee does not cover.** It applies to figures. Qualitative statements are drawn from the institution's own STARS narrative answers, but no mechanical check confirms that a sentence describing them is faithful. **"With reference to", not "in accordance with".** GRI reserves **in accordance** for reports answering every Universal Disclosure plus all disclosures for each material topic. This report does not, so it makes the weaker and correct claim. **Source and attribution.** [University College Cork STARS Report](<https://reports.aashe.org/institutions/university-college-cork-national-university-of-ireland-cork-co-corcaigh/report/2026-03-05/>), AASHE. STARS data is publicly accessible and used here with attribution to AASHE; it is not openly licensed.

The organisation and its reporting

Organisational Details and Reporting Boundary

University College Cork is a public higher education institution. In accordance with GRI 2-1 and GRI 2-2, this report encompasses the university's main campus and associated satellite campuses managed directly by the Buildings and Estates office. Activities and physical features included within this operational scope cover the medical school, museum facilities, and satellite locations, reflecting the physical footprint under direct administrative control as outlined in GRI 2-6.

Specific subsidiary entities are excluded from the reporting boundary, namely Campus Accommodation, the Mardyke Arena, the Student Centre, and the Irish Management Institute (Dublin). Rented multi-tenant properties are likewise omitted. Because residential subsidiary operations are excluded while enrolled students remain included within full-time-equivalent headcounts, per-capita intensity figures may be biased downwards. Furthermore, while the source framework collects descriptive details of campus operations, it does not collect structured disclosures regarding the legal name,

headquarters location, countries of operation, or complete supply chain and market details required by GRI 2-1 and GRI 2-6.

Reporting Period and Governance

The compilation of sustainability data was led by Dr Maria Kirrane, Head of Sustainability and Climate. In relation to GRI 2-3, reporting periods vary across operational categories within the source assessment; for Scope 1 and Scope 2 greenhouse gas emissions, the applicable performance year is 2024.

The source framework does not record publication dates, overall reporting frequency, or dedicated contact details beyond the designated lead personnel under GRI 2-3. Additionally, under GRI 2-4, restatements of information from prior assessment cycles are not reported, as the data collection format evaluates each reporting period independently.

External Assurance

External assurance was undertaken for specific environmental data under GRI 2-5. Greenhouse gas emissions figures covering Scope 1 and Scope 2 were verified by the university's external carbon footprint provider, Sustineo. The source framework does not record the assurance standard employed, the level of assurance obtained, specific assessment limitations, or the formal governance relationship with the assurance provider.

Activities and workers

University College Cork maintains a workforce with a total full-time equivalent of 3,643. This figure, reported in accordance with Disclosure 2-7, represents the total volume of labour utilised by the institution. In line with the reporting methodology, this value is a measure of full-time equivalence rather than a raw headcount; consequently, multiple part-time staff members may be represented as a single unit within this total.

Workforce Composition and Activities

The activities performed by the workforce encompass academic instruction, research, and professional services. Internal rubrics for staff progression indicate that employees contribute to the community, industry, and public service at local, regional, national, and international levels. These contributions include engagement with neighbourhood and regional development, as well as professional service to industry and public bodies.

Staff are also involved in activities related to the student experience, such as recruitment, hosting open days, and conducting school visits. Operational data regarding the institution's environmental impact further indicates that the workforce operates through a mix of on-site attendance and working-from-home arrangements.

Data Limitations and Omissions

While the total full-time equivalent is recorded, this report cannot provide the specific breakdowns required by Disclosure 2-7. The source data does not differentiate employees by gender or by region. Furthermore, the institution does not report a breakdown of the workforce by employment contract type, such as permanent or temporary contracts, nor by employment type, such as full-time or part-time status.

Regarding Disclosure 2-8, this report does not include data on workers who are not employees but whose work is controlled by the university. The STARS framework, which serves as the primary data source, does not collect a headcount of individuals working under third-party contracts or similar arrangements. Consequently, the scale and nature of the non-employee workforce remain unquantified in this section.

Material topics

Approach to Materiality

The sustainability topics addressed in this report are derived from the Sustainability Tracking, Assessment & Rating System (STARS) framework. This framework is designed by the Association for the Advancement of Sustainability in Higher Education (AASHE) to provide a standardised set of credits for the higher education sector. Consequently, University College Cork did not conduct a bespoke materiality assessment to identify these topics. This report cannot evidence a specific process for identifying and prioritising impacts on the economy, environment, and people as required by Disclosure 3-1, as the credit set is fixed by AASHE and is identical for all participating institutions.

List of Material Topics

The institution has adopted measurable sustainability objectives across five broad areas defined by the STARS framework:

- Campus operations
- Teaching, learning, and research
- Racial equity and social justice
- Administration and finance
- Campus and community engagement

These categories are fixed within the STARS credit set. This report does not record changes in material topics against previous reporting periods, as such comparisons are not facilitated by a single STARS submission. The inclusion of these areas indicates that the institution has set objectives within them, rather than representing a determination of significant impact made by the institution itself.

Management of Material Topics

Sustainability at University College Cork is managed through the Office of Sustainability and Climate Action, led by the Head of Sustainability and Climate Action. This office coordinates the Green Campus Committee, the Green Forum, and the University Leadership Team Subcommittee on Sustainability and Climate Action. The institution has made a public commitment to sustainability through the publication of its Sustainability and Climate Action Plan.

Within this plan, the university has committed to several operational objectives. These include exceeding government targets for the reduction of Scope 1 and Scope 2 greenhouse gas emissions and achieving net zero total greenhouse gas emissions. The university also aims to adapt estate management policies and infrastructure to mitigate climate change impacts, utilise the campus as a living laboratory for climate solutions, and prioritise the protection and restoration of campus green space.

Recent activities and accomplishments include the awarding of the Green Flag from the Foundation for Environmental Education, maintaining a high UI Green Metric Ranking, and the coordination of the Green Campus Living Laboratory Fund. The university also conducts mapping of its curriculum to evaluate the integration of sustainability and the Sustainable Development Goals across its academic programmes.

Reporting Limitations

This report provides institution-wide management information rather than the topic-specific disclosures required by GRI 3-3. The STARS framework does not collect data on specific impacts, the role of business relationships in those impacts, or lessons learned. Furthermore, the source material reports on outcomes rather than distinguishing between actions taken to prevent potential harm and those taken to remediate actual harm. STARS does not collect information regarding a formal materiality determination process, and this report cannot evidence such a process.

Governance

Governance Structure and Composition

The highest decision-making body at University College Cork is the Governing Authority. This body includes representation from across the university community, specifically including academic staff, staff representing non-managerial workers, and student representatives. Academic staff representation is facilitated through two positions on the Governing Authority which are democratically elected by the staff of the institution.

While the presence of these representatives is confirmed, this report cannot evidence the full numeric composition of the body as required by GRI 2-9, such as the number of executive and non-executive members, their independence, tenure, or other significant

positions held. Furthermore, the source material does not provide a breakdown of the governing body by gender or membership of under-represented social groups.

Delegation of Responsibility for Managing Impacts

The institution delegates responsibility for the advancement of sustainability through dedicated officers and committees. The Head of Sustainability and Climate Action leads these efforts, supported by a Sustainability Support Officer and a Greenshoots coordinator, the latter of whom focuses specifically on student engagement. These roles are tasked with coordinating various campus constituencies to integrate sustainability across the entire institution.

Staff are expected to align their activities with the goals set out in the university strategy and the Sustainability and Climate Action Plan. Advocacy within the institution is expected to be conducted through the lens of the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals. In terms of investment stewardship, the institution recognises the value of collective action and prioritises collaborative efforts, maintaining guidelines on environmental, social, and governance factors, as well as specific guidelines on climate change and exclusions.

The reporting lines between these sustainability officers and the highest governance body are not consistently stated in the source material, and STARS does not collect information regarding the frequency with which these executives report to the Governing Authority on the management of impacts.

Role in Sustainability Reporting

The highest governance body's involvement in sustainability reporting is evidenced by an executive cover letter accompanying the submission. However, the source does not record whether the Governing Authority or a senior executive formally reviewed and approved the reported information or the identified material topics.

Limitations and Omissions

Several aspects of governance required by the GRI Standards are not captured by the STARS framework or were not reported by the institution. This report cannot evidence the criteria and processes for nominating and selecting members of the Governing Authority (GRI 2-10), nor does it record information regarding the chair of this body or potential conflicts of interest (GRI 2-11, GRI 2-15).

The source does not describe the specific role of the Governing Authority in overseeing due diligence or reviewing the effectiveness of impact management (GRI 2-12). There is no data available regarding the communication of critical concerns to the highest governance body (GRI 2-16), the measures taken to advance its collective knowledge on sustainable development (GRI 2-17), or the processes for evaluating its performance (GRI 2-18). Finally, the institution does not report on remuneration policies and processes for

the governing body and senior executives (GRI 2-19, GRI 2-20), and the annual total compensation ratio (GRI 2-21) was left blank.

Strategy, policies and practices

University College Cork (UCC) defines its sustainability vision through the Sustainability and Climate Action Plan. This strategy builds on previous frameworks to embed sustainability goals across education, research, university operations, infrastructural developments, and community engagement. The institution aims to achieve significant environmental targets, including attaining a status of zero waste and becoming a carbon neutral campus.

Under Disclosure 2-23, the university has established public commitments to sustainability, which include requirements set by the Irish government to reduce absolute greenhouse gas emissions. The institution publishes annual roadmaps to outline the steps taken toward these objectives. To embed these policy commitments, as described in Disclosure 2-24, UCC maintains a code of conduct for suppliers that details social and environmental expectations. Internal responsibility is co-ordinated by the Head of Sustainability and Climate Action, who leads the Office of Sustainability and Climate Action and facilitates the work of the Green Campus Committee and the Green Forum. Recent accomplishments include the publication of the university's climate action plan and the receipt of Green Flag awards. Sustainability training is made available to non-academic staff on an annual basis.

Regarding mechanisms for seeking advice and raising concerns, UCC provides accessible information to employees on grievance resolution and whistleblower protections. As outlined for Disclosure 2-25 and Disclosure 2-26, these measures include frameworks for addressing sexual violence and harassment, a disclosures policy, and information on employee rights and trade union representation.

This report notes several limitations in the available data. For Disclosure 2-22, the source material does not attribute the sustainability statement to a named senior executive or the highest governance body. Regarding Disclosure 2-23, the reported commitments focus on sustainability rather than human rights or the UN Guiding Principles, and the source only includes commitments with a reporting requirement. Disclosure 2-24 does not detail the internal allocation of responsibility or the integration of commitments into all business relationships, and training data is restricted to non-academic staff. Mechanisms for remediation and advice (Disclosure 2-25 and Disclosure 2-26) are reported for employees only and do not describe operational effectiveness for all stakeholders. The institution's memberships in associations are not reported under Disclosure 2-28, as the source material is restricted to reporting-linked commitments. Finally, the source does not report data for Disclosure 2-27, as STARS does not collect information on legal compliance, fines, or regulatory enforcement.

Stakeholder engagement

The University College Cork (UCC) approach to stakeholder engagement is integrated into its strategic planning and governance structures, focusing on deliberative participation and transparency.

Student Consultation

The UCC Student Forum serves as a primary mechanism for student involvement in institutional decision-making. Modelled on the Irish Citizens' Assembly, the forum is designed as an exercise in deliberative and participatory democracy. It aims to place students at the centre of strategic and policy issues, moving beyond access to ensure active involvement in the university community. The forum is intended to strengthen the integrity of decision-making processes and cultivate citizens who contribute to the common good.

Staff Consultation

Academic staff are consulted through the Academic Leadership Forum, a non-executive body that provides a reference group for academic strategy. This forum initiates discussions on matters of university interest—such as academic strategy and intake quotas—for reference to the Academic Council or Academic Board. It also coordinates university input on national and international academic agendas, including calls from the Higher Education Authority (HEA) and the Department of Education and Skills (DES). The forum promotes inter-disciplinary research-based approaches and facilitates connections between teaching and research across various colleges and schools.

Community Engagement

UCC maintains ongoing engagement with the local community, specifically through support for the Magazine Road Residents Association. The university also operates standing bodies through which local community-based organisations not affiliated with the institution can participate democratically in its governance.

Engaged Research Framework

The university employs an Engaged Research Framework to facilitate collaboration between researchers and societal partners. This framework encourages public engagement and involvement throughout the research process, ensuring that research is conducted with societal partners rather than for them. Stakeholders, including members of the public, technical experts, service providers, and community organisations, are invited to inform research plans, refine methodological frameworks, and establish pathways to impact.

Limitations and Gaps

This report cannot evidence the specific methods used to identify stakeholders or the measures taken to ensure engagement is meaningful, as Disclosure GRI 2-29 requirements in these areas are not fully covered by the STARS framework. Furthermore, STARS focuses on fixed constituencies and does not specifically cover engagement with suppliers, customers, or vulnerable groups.

The institution does not report the percentage of total employees covered by collective bargaining agreements. While Disclosure GRI 2-30 requires this data, the STARS framework instead records whether freedom-of-association information is published in Disclosure PA-[figure] and the percentage of significant contractors paying specific wage levels in Disclosure PA-[figure], which represent different populations and metrics.

Environmental performance

Energy Consumption and Intensity

Under GRI 302-1, total annual energy consumption within University College Cork was 55,148.70 Megawatt-hours. Total electricity consumption accounted for 32,599.70 Megawatt-hours, while total stationary fuel consumption was 22,549 Megawatt-hours. Off-site heating and cooling imported by the institution stood at 0 Megawatt-hours. On-site renewable electricity exported to the grid was 0 Megawatt-hours.

Stationary combustion by fuel type comprised 22,549 Megawatt-hours of natural gas, 0 Megawatt-hours of heating oil, 0 Megawatt-hours of propane/LPG, and 0 Megawatt-hours of coal and coke. Total renewable energy consumption was 0.70 Megawatt-hours, while consumption of renewable stationary fuels was 0 Megawatt-hours.

Energy intensity under GRI 302-3 was 2,139.20 Kilowatt-hours and 195.31 Kilowatt-hours per square meter. These intensity metrics reflect an institutional boundary that excludes specific subsidiary operations, including Campus Accommodation, Mardyke Arena, the Student Centre, and the Irish Management Institute, alongside rented multi-tenant spaces.

Water Withdrawal

Under GRI 303-3, total water withdrawal was 54,153 Cubic meters. All withdrawn water was sourced from third-party municipal supplies, with potable water from off-site sources standing at 54,153 Cubic meters and on-site withdrawal at 0 Cubic meters. Under Disclosure 303-1, the physical water quantity risk for the main campus is classified as low-medium, and on-site rainwater harvesting is operational.

Greenhouse Gas Emissions

Direct Scope 1 greenhouse gas emissions under GRI 305-1 totalled 6,215.78 Metric tons of CO₂ equivalent. Within Scope 1, stationary combustion emissions were 5,517 Metric

tons of CO2 equivalent, mobile combustion emissions were 62.78 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent, and fugitive emissions accounted for 636 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent. Process emissions were not reported. Biogenic emissions stood at 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent.

Energy indirect Scope 2 emissions under GRI 305-2 were 8,144 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent. Calculated via the location-based method, off-site electricity emissions were 8,144 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent. Market-based electricity emissions were 8,144 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent, and emissions from off-site heating and cooling were 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent. Inventories follow GHG Protocol standards and ISO 14064-1 methodologies prepared by Sustineo.

Other indirect Scope 3 emissions under GRI 305-3 comprised 1,572 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent from purchased goods and services, 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent from capital goods, 3,318 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent from fuel- and energy-related activities not included in Scope 1 or Scope 2, 3,565 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent from business travel, and 20,991 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent from employee and student commuting. Operational waste Scope 3 emissions were not reported.

Under GRI 305-4, combined Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions intensity was 557.01 Kilograms of CO2 equivalent and 50.86 Kilograms per square meter. Under GRI 305-5, emissions performance is evaluated against the baseline year 2017, which reflects the Irish public sector baseline mandate. Baseline combined Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions were 19,460 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent. Net Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions stood at 14,359.78 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent, achieving a reduction from baseline of 26.21%. Third-party certified carbon offsets retired were 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent.

Waste Management

Under GRI 306-3, annual non-hazardous waste generation was 520 Metric tons, and construction and demolition waste generation was 6,914.08 Metric tons.

Under GRI 306-4, non-hazardous waste diverted from disposal totalled 242 Metric tons, comprising 183 Metric tons recycled, 59 Metric tons composted, and 0 Metric tons prepared for reuse. Diverted construction and demolition waste totalled 6,837.95 Metric tons, with 5,675.22 Metric tons recycled and 1,162.73 Metric tons prepared for reuse.

Under GRI 306-5, non-hazardous waste directed to disposal across landfill and incineration was 278 Metric tons, while construction and demolition waste directed to disposal was 76.13 Metric tons.

Under Disclosure 306-2, waste impact mitigation measures include surplus programmes for institutional assets, reuse systems for staff and student donations, the elimination of specific single-use plastics, acceptance of compostable packaging in food waste systems, and hazardous waste management protocols.

Supplier Environmental Assessment

Under GRI 308-1, the proportion of bid solicitations incorporating supplier sustainability considerations was 21%. The supplier code of conduct does not mandate environmental standards beyond regulatory requirements.

Limitations and Unreported Disclosures

Data collection through STARS differs from GRI presentation standards in several respects: - Units: GRI 302-1 expects energy in joules (STARS collects megawatt-hours), and GRI 303-3 requires water volumes in megalitres (STARS collects cubic metres). - Scope and details: STARS aggregates landfill and incineration within GRI 306-5, does not weigh hazardous waste streams for GRI 306-3, and reports combined baseline data across Scope 1 and Scope 2 under GRI 305-5. - Unreported items: As higher education institutions do not manufacture commercial physical products, GRI 301-1, Disclosure 301-2, Disclosure 301-3, and GRI 302-5 are not applicable. STARS does not collect value-chain energy under GRI 302-2, energy reductions under GRI 302-4, effluent discharge standards under GRI 303-2, ozone-depleting substances under GRI 305-6, significant air emissions under GRI 305-7, process descriptions under GRI 306-1, or supplier environmental assessment outcomes under GRI 308-2. Scope 1 process emissions and Scope 3 operational waste emissions were omitted from the institutional return.

Social and economic performance

Remuneration and Pay Equity

University College Cork reports that 100% of its employees receive remuneration equivalent to at least a living wage, which is defined as 15.40. The wage floor for regular and permanent employees is 16.40. For student workers, the local hourly minimum wage is 14.25. These values are reported in Euros.

The institution has published its fourth annual gender pay gap report, which tracks mean and median pay gaps. While the university policy and national legislation mandate equal pay for equal work, the institution identifies that representation patterns—specifically fewer women in senior academic and professional roles and more women in entry-grade or part-time positions—contribute to the existing gap.

Employment Conditions and Parental Leave

The institution reports that 100% of employees are eligible for paid all-gender family or medical leave. Under maternity legislation, all women are entitled to a total of 42 weeks of maternity leave. This entitlement consists of 26 weeks of paid leave, followed by an additional 16 weeks of unpaid leave. The university provides full pay during the initial 26-week period.

Occupational Health and Safety

The University maintains a Safety Representative Forum to enhance the health, safety, and welfare of employees and students. This forum facilitates consultation between management and staff safety representatives, who are tasked with conducting workplace safety tours, reviewing accident and dangerous occurrence reports, and contributing to initiatives aimed at improving safety culture.

The institution provides various health and wellbeing services to its workforce, including physical health services, behavioural health services, and access to fitness activities. Contemplative and spiritual activities are also made available. Smoking and tobacco use are not prohibited across the entire campus.

Workforce Diversity

Workforce diversity is monitored across different employee categories. The percentage of executive staff identifying as women or other marginalised gender identities is 47%. For regular permanent academic staff, this figure is 49%, and for non-academic staff, it is 63%.

Ethnic diversity is reported using a concentration index. The ethnic diversity index for executive staff is 0, while the index for academic staff is 0.44 and for non-academic staff is 0.34.

Data Limitations and Omissions

This report is subject to several data limitations. Disclosure 202-1 is partially satisfied; while a ratio of the wage floor to the local minimum wage is derivable, the source material does not provide a breakdown by gender. The minimum wage figure used refers specifically to student workers. Disclosure 401-2 provides an institution-wide eligibility rate but does not distinguish between benefits for full-time, part-time, or temporary staff. Disclosure 401-3 reports on maternity policy rather than the headcounts, return-to-work, or retention rates required by the standard.

Occupational health and safety disclosures (GRI 403) lack specific data on legal requirements, meeting frequency, and the total number of workers covered by a formal management system. Disclosure 405-1 uses a diversity index rather than a percentage breakdown and does not include data on employee age groups. Furthermore, while constituencies on the highest decision-making body are identified, their percentage of the total body is not reported.

The following disclosures are not reported as the source material does not collect the necessary data: local hiring of senior management (GRI 202-2), local supplier spending (GRI 204-1), employee turnover (GRI 401-1), specific hazard identification and incident investigation processes (GRI 403-2), health and safety training (GRI 403-5), health impacts linked to business relationships (GRI 403-7), work-related injury and ill health rates (GRI 403-9, GRI 403-10), and the ratio of basic salary and remuneration of women to men (GRI 405-2).

GRI content index

Reported	Partially reported	Not reported	Not assessed
26	14	38	0

“With reference to”, not “in accordance with.” GRI reserves in accordance for reports answering every Universal Disclosure (GRI 2) plus all disclosures for each material topic. This report does not, so it uses the weaker and correct claim.

GRI 2: General Disclosures 2021

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-1 Organizational details	Reported	Institutional control: Public	GRI 2-1 also requires the legal name, the location of headquarters and the countries of operation. STARS carries none of these as fields — they are report metadata, not credit data.
2-2 Entities included in the organization’s sustainability reporting	Reported	Narrative outlining the institutional boundary used to complete this report: This submission covers all of UCC main campus and satellite campuses that are under the...	GRI 2-2-a, the entities included in the report. STARS collects this as a free-text boundary narrative, so it answers the disclosure but is not structured as GRI’s list of entities. △ THE THREE SUBMISSIONS DO NOT SHARE A REPORTING BOUNDARY , so figures normalised per person or per unit of area are not like-for-like across them. Cork’s boundary narrative excludes its subsidiary companies by name — Campus Accommodation, the Mardyke Arena, the Student Centre and the Irish Management Institute — and excludes rented multi-tenant buildings; Berkeley’s covers everything under its operational control, residences and grounds included. This biases Cork’s per-person figures DOWNWARD : students living in Campus Accommodation still count in its full-time-equivalent denominator while their residential consumption falls outside the numerator. Per-area figures are less affected, since the excluded buildings are missing from both halves. Where such a figure is cited comparatively, name the boundary difference; never present the gap as performance alone.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-3 Reporting period, frequency and contact point	Partially reported	Performance year for scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 2024 List of personnel who led the reporting process: Dr Maria Kirrane, Head of Sustainability and Climate	STARS has no single reporting period, and the per-credit years diverge inside one submission: Cork's credits run from 2023 (construction waste) to 2025 (living wage, investment), Berkeley's from 2023 to 2024. Only TU Dublin is uniform, at 2023. Any single period stated for a GRI report built on this data would be wrong for some of its figures. GRI 2-3 also requires the reporting frequency, the publication date and a contact point; STARS collects none of these. Named preparers are not a designated contact point: STARS records names and roles without contact details, and does not say who should receive enquiries.
2-4 Restatements of information	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS v2.2 and earlier scored Operations credits against the institution's own baseline and v3.0 scores against a peer group, so cross-version figures are not comparable in the first place — see CLAUDE.md 6.4.
2-5 External assurance	Reported	Were any independent audits or external assurance processes used in the preparation of this report?: Yes Narrative outlining the independent audits or external assurance processes used in the preparation of this report: Emissions figures were verified by the University's contracted carbon footprint provide...	GRI 2-5 additionally requires the assurance standard used, the level of assurance obtained, the limitations of the process and the relationship with the assurance provider. STARS captures none of these; the free-text field is optional and unstructured. Only populated where the institution answered yes to the assurance question, so it is absent for most submissions.
2-6 Activities, value chain and other business relationships	Partially reported	Which of the following features are included within the institutional boundary?: Medical school Museum Satellite campus(es)	GRI 2-6 asks for the sectors the organization is active in, its value chain, its products and services and the markets served. A list of campus features covers only the activities, and only those with a physical footprint.
2-7 Employees	Partially reported	Full-time equivalent of employees: 3,643	FTE is not a headcount: two half-time staff count as one. GRI 2-7 further requires the breakdown by employment contract (permanent / temporary), by employment type (full- / part-time), by gender and by region. STARS collects a single undifferentiated figure.
2-8 Workers who are not employees	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-9 Governance structure and composition	Reported	Are one or more academic staff representatives included as members of the institution's highest decision-making body?: Yes Are one or more staff members representing non-managerial workers included as members of the institution's highest decision-making body?: Yes Are one or more student representatives included as members of the institution's highest decision-making body?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL outlining academic staff representation on the institution's highest decision-making body: Two spaces on the UCC Governing Authority democratically elected by staff of UCC. https...	GRI 2-9 also requires the number of executive and non-executive members, their independence, tenure, other significant positions held, and composition by gender and under-represented social group. STARS records only whether each constituency is represented. See the caveat on the academic-staff row: representation is recorded, composition is not. See the caveat on the academic-staff row. Free text of variable depth; it is not a substitute for the numeric composition GRI 2-9-c requires.
2-10 Nomination and selection of the highest governance body	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-11 Chair of the highest governance body	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-12 Role of the highest governance body in overseeing the management of impacts	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-13 Delegation of responsibility for managing impacts	Reported	Does the institution have one or more sustainability officers?: Yes Is at least one of the institution's sustainability committees, officers, or offices charged with coordinating various campus constituencies in the advancement of sustainability across the entire institution?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's sustainability officers: Dr Maria Kirrane is the University's Head of Sustainability and Climate Action, while S...	GRI 2-13-b also requires whether and how often those executives report to the highest governance body. STARS does not ask. See the caveat on the sustainability-officer row. Free text; the reporting line to the highest governance body is not consistently stated.
2-14 Role of the highest governance body in sustainability reporting	Partially reported	Executive cover letter: 03.03.26-STARSProgrammeSubmission.pdf	Endorsement by a senior executive is not review and approval by the highest governance body, and STARS records neither who approved the content nor whether material topics were reviewed. The field value is an attachment filename, so the letter's text is not in the dataset.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-15 Conflicts of interest	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-16 Communication of critical concerns	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-17 Collective knowledge of the highest governance body	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-18 Evaluation of the performance of the highest governance body	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-19 Remuneration policies	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-20 Process to determine remuneration	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-21 Annual total compensation ratio	Not reported	Mapped to STARS, but this institution left every mapped field blank.	The denominator differs and the difference is large. GRI 2-21 divides the highest-paid individual by the MEDIAN of all other employees; STARS divides the highest-paid senior administrator by the LOWEST-paid full-time employee. The STARS figure is therefore a top-to-bottom spread, not a top-to-typical ratio, and is not comparable with any GRI 2-21 figure published elsewhere. IL-62 is also an Innovation & Leadership bonus credit, so it is optional: only TU Dublin reports it (8.08); Berkeley and Cork leave it blank.
2-22 Statement on sustainable development strategy	Partially reported	Narrative detailing the institution's guiding vision or goals for sustainability and the plan(s) in which they are published: The Sustainability and Climate Action Plan (2023-2028) builds on the successes of UCC's...	GRI 2-22 requires the statement to come from the highest governance body or the most senior executive. STARS records the institution's published vision without attributing it to a named signatory, so the authorship the disclosure turns on is absent.
2-23 Policy commitments	Reported	Has the institution made a public commitment to sustainability, as evidenced by an external commitment or a published plan?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL outlining the institution's external sustainability commitments that include a reporting requirement: UCC is required by the Irish government to reduce our absolute GHG emissions by 51% by ...	GRI 2-23 specifically requires commitments to respect human rights, to the UN Guiding Principles and to due diligence. A sustainability commitment is broader and does not imply any of these. STARS asks only for commitments carrying a reporting requirement, so commitments without one are out of scope of the field.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-24 Embedding policy commitments	Reported	Does the institution have a published code of conduct to guide suppliers on the institution's social and environmental expectations for them?: Yes Does the institution make available sustainability-focused training opportunities to non-academic staff on at least an annual basis?: Yes Narrative outlining the activities and substantive accomplishments of the institution-wide coordinating body or officer during the previous three years: The Head of Sustainability and Climate Action coordinates the Office of Sustainability ...	GRI 2-24 also requires how responsibility is allocated internally and how the commitments are embedded in strategies and procedures. STARS asks about non-academic staff only, and about sustainability training generally rather than training on the specific commitments. It describes outcomes, not the allocation of responsibility, the integration into procedures, or the handling of commitments through business relationships that GRI 2-24-a enumerates.
2-25 Processes to remediate negative impacts	Partially reported	Does the institution publish information on grievance resolution in a format that is accessible to all employees?: Yes	STARS records only that the information is published — not how the mechanism operates, who may use it, or its effectiveness — and covers employees only, where GRI 2-25 covers all affected stakeholders.
2-26 Mechanisms for seeking advice and raising concerns	Reported	Does the institution publish information on whistleblower protections in a format that is accessible to all employees?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's published measures to protect employee rights: https://www.ucc.ie/en/edi/sexual-violence-harassment-framework/ https://www.ucc.ie/en/h...	STARS records publication, not a description of how the mechanism operates, and covers employees only. GRI 2-26 extends to all individuals, including those in business relationships. Employees only; see the caveat on the whistleblower row.
2-27 Compliance with laws and regulations	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
2-28 Membership associations	Partially reported	Narrative and/or website URL outlining the institution's external sustainability commitments that include a reporting requirement: UCC is required by the Irish government to reduce our absolute GHG emissions by 51% by ...	Signing a charter is not membership of an association, and STARS restricts the field to commitments carrying a reporting requirement. The institution's association memberships are not collected as such.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
2-29 Approach to stakeholder engagement	Reported	Description of other mechanisms used to consult students on institutional decisions, plans, or policies: Born from UCC's strategic plan, the UCC Student Forum is an exercise in deliberative an... Description of other mechanisms used to consult academic staff on institutional decisions, plans, or policies: The Academic Leadership Forum in UCC is Non-executive forum for academic leadership of ... Narrative and/or website URL outlining the ad hoc mechanisms used during the previous three years to consult local community members on institutional decisions, plans, or policies: UCC supports and actively engages with the local Magazine Road Residents Association, e... Does the institution have one or more ongoing bodies through which local community-based organizations not affiliated with the institution can democratically participate in its governance?: Yes	GRI 2-29 also asks how stakeholders are identified and how the organization ensures the engagement is meaningful. STARS asks about four fixed constituencies and does not cover suppliers, customers or vulnerable groups. See the caveat on the student-consultation row.
2-30 Collective bargaining agreements	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 3: Material Topics 2021

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
3-1 Process to determine material topics	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	A structural difference between the two FRAMEWORKS, not missing data and not a criticism of the institution. GRI assumes the organisation identifies and prioritises its own impacts; STARS assumes AASHE settled that for the higher-education sector and asks the institution to answer a fixed credit set. △ DO NOT WRITE THAT THE INSTITUTION DID NOT CONDUCT, DID NOT RUN, OR DOES NOT CARRY OUT A MATERIALITY ASSESSMENT. Nothing here supports it; STARS never asked, so a university that ran one has nowhere to say so. The defensible statement is that this report cannot evidence such a process, and that the topics it covers are AASHE's sector-level determination rather than an institution-specific one. PA-2 records a climate-vulnerability assessment and PA-3 records stakeholder consultation, but neither is a materiality process and neither should be presented as one.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
3-2 List of material topics	Partially reported	Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address campus operations?: Yes Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address teaching, learning, and/or research?: Yes Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address racial equity and/or social justice?: Yes Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address administration and/or finance?: Yes Has the institution adopted one or more measurable sustainability objectives that address campus and/or community engagement?: Yes	NOT A MATERIALITY DETERMINATION. These five areas are fixed by STARS and identical for every institution, so they say where an institution has set objectives, not which impacts it judged significant and why. GRI 3-2-b also requires changes against the previous reporting period, which a single STARS submission cannot show. Presenting these as material topics would overstate what this dataset establishes: it shows that objectives exist in an area, never how that area was chosen. Whether the institution determined its own topics outside STARS is not recorded here either way, and must not be asserted in either direction. See the campus-operations row: fixed areas, not a materiality determination.
3-3 Management of material topics	Partially reported	Narrative listing the institution's measurable sustainability objectives that address campus operations: Within the University's Sustainability and Climate Action Plan 2023-28, UCC has committ... Narrative outlining the activities and substantive accomplishments of the institution-wide coordinating body or officer during the previous three years: The Head of Sustainability and Climate Action coordinates the Office of Sustainability ... Has the institution made a public commitment to sustainability, as evidenced by an external commitment or a published plan?: Yes	Asked per material topic, and no material-topics list exists (see GRI 3-2) — so these are institution-wide answers to a question GRI asks topic by topic. GRI 3-3 also requires the impacts themselves (3-3-a), whether the organisation is involved through its own activities or its business relationships (3-3-b), and lessons learned (3-3-e-iv). STARS collects none of those. It reports outcomes rather than distinguishing actions that prevent potential harm from actions that remediate actual harm, which is the split GRI 3-3-d asks for.

GRI 202: Market Presence 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
202-1 Ratios of standard entry level wage by gender compared to local minimum wage	Reported	Percentage of employees that receive remuneration equivalent to at least a living wage: 100 Living wage: 15.40 Wage floor for regular/permanent employees: 16.40 Local hourly minimum wage for students: 14.25	PARTIALLY SATISFIES GRI 202-1, AND THE RATIO IS DERIVABLE. Both terms are in STARS: PA-13's Wage floor for regular/permanent employees is the standard entry-level wage, and PA-9's Local hourly minimum wage for students is the local statutory minimum. Berkeley $22.54/16.99 = 1.33$, Cork $16.40/14.25 = 1.15$, TU Dublin $16.53/12.70 = 1.30$. Δ TWO LIMITS REMAIN. The minimum-wage field sits in a student-employment credit, so it is the minimum applying to student workers rather than one stated for the workforce generally — in all three cases it matches the statutory local minimum, but say which figure is being used. And GRI requires the ratio BY GENDER, which STARS does not collect at any credit; that half is unanswerable, not merely unsupplied. STARS separately benchmarks pay against a LIVING wage, which is a different and higher threshold than the minimum wage and must not be substituted for it. Values are bare numbers with no currency - EUR for the Irish universities, USD for Berkeley - and are not comparable across them without saying so. It lives in PA-9, a student-employment credit, so it is the minimum applying to student workers. In all three cases it matches the local statutory minimum (Berkeley 16.99, the City of Berkeley rate; Cork 14.25; TU Dublin 12.70, Ireland's national minimum), but the scoping should be stated rather than glossed.
202-2 Proportion of senior management hired from the local community	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	No STARS credit collects this.

GRI 204: Procurement Practices 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
204-1 Proportion of spending on local suppliers	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 301: Materials 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
301-1 Materials used by weight or volume	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	This is a sector-fit finding of the same kind as AC-1 and EN-1 on the STARS side: the framework and the institution type do not line up.
301-2 Recycled input materials used	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
301-3 Reclaimed products and their packaging materials	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 302: Energy 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
302-1 Energy consumption within the organization	Reported	Total annual energy consumption: 55,148.70 Megawatt-hours Total electricity consumption: 32,599.70 Megawatt-hours Total stationary fuel consumption: 22,549 Megawatt-hours Annual renewable energy consumption: 0.70 Megawatt-hours Renewable stationary fuels: 0 Megawatt-hours Total heating and cooling from off-site sources: 0 Megawatt-hours On-site renewable electricity exported: 0 Megawatt-hours Natural gas: 22,549 Megawatt-hours Heating oil: 0 Megawatt-hours Coal/coke: 0 Megawatt-hours Propane/LPG: 0 Megawatt-hours	GRI 302-1 expects joules or multiples and requires fuel consumption split into renewable and non-renewable. STARS reports megawatt-hours. Δ DO NOT CONVERT IN PROSE, AND DO NOT STATE THE CONVERSION FACTOR. A conversion factor is a figure, and no figure may enter the narrative that the code did not substitute. Report the STARS value in its own units and name the unit difference in words; if a figure in GRI's units is ever required, derive it in code from the verified value. Δ BERKELEY ONLY, AND IT IS AN INCOMPLETE RETURN RATHER THAN A RESULT. Berkeley's reported stationary fuel consumption is far too small — by a factor of roughly twenty-five — to have produced the stationary combustion emissions it reports in the same submission, and no fuel burns at that intensity. Its own emissions methodology names natural gas from the campus cogeneration plant as a Scope 1 source, while its energy return records no on-site non-renewable electricity at all: the plant is in the emissions inventory and absent from the energy one. State plainly that Berkeley's energy total is incomplete and that the size of the gap cannot be established from this data. Do NOT present Berkeley's energy figures as an efficiency achievement, and do NOT repeat any of this in Cork's or TU Dublin's report — neither shows the mismatch. GRI 302-1-a is fuel consumption from non-renewable sources. This is the STARS total for it, and the figure the cogeneration arithmetic below turns on. SCOPE MISMATCH. GRI 302-1-b is 'Total fuel consumption from renewable sources'. This STARS field also includes renewable ELECTRICITY (Berkeley 18,173 MWh), so it is broader than GRI's line and would overstate renewable fuel. The precise match is 'Renewable stationary fuels' - see the row below, which is ~0 for all three. Use this field only for a general renewables statement, never for GRI 302-1-b. Correct but near-empty: 0.21 MWh for TU Dublin, 0 for Cork and Berkeley. A finding in itself - these universities' renewable energy is almost entirely purchased electricity, not renewable fuel. GRI 302-1-b is therefore honestly reportable as ~zero. GRI 302-1 requires joules; STARS reports MMBtu or MWh, so this value is not in GRI's unit as collected. Zero for all three institutions in the current reporting year, so the mapping is correct but currently carries no signal. GRI 302-1 expects joules; STARS reports MWh. Zero at Cork; a small residual at TU Dublin and Berkeley. Units are MWh, not joules. A reported zero, not missing data. STARS also carries an Other stationary fuels catch-all, also zero everywhere, which is what makes this list of fuel types complete rather than merely partial.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
302-2 Energy consumption outside of the organization	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
302-3 Energy intensity	Reported	Annual energy consumption per person: 2,139.20 Kilowatt-hours Annual energy consumption per unit of floor area: 195.31 Kilowatt-hours per square meter	GRI 302-3 energy intensity, normalised per person. Δ THE THREE SUBMISSIONS DO NOT SHARE A REPORTING BOUNDARY, so figures normalised per person or per unit of area are not like-for-like across them. Cork's boundary narrative excludes its subsidiary companies by name — Campus Accommodation, the Mardyke Arena, the Student Centre and the Irish Management Institute — and excludes rented multi-tenant buildings; Berkeley's covers everything under its operational control, residences and grounds included. This biases Cork's per-person figures DOWNWARD: students living in Campus Accommodation still count in its full-time-equivalent denominator while their residential consumption falls outside the numerator. Per-area figures are less affected, since the excluded buildings are missing from both halves. Where such a figure is cited comparatively, name the boundary difference; never present the gap as performance alone. Δ BERKELEY ONLY, AND IT IS AN INCOMPLETE RETURN RATHER THAN A RESULT. Berkeley's reported stationary fuel consumption is far too small — by a factor of roughly twenty-five — to have produced the stationary combustion emissions it reports in the same submission, and no fuel burns at that intensity. Its own emissions methodology names natural gas from the campus cogeneration plant as a Scope 1 source, while its energy return records no on-site non-renewable electricity at all: the plant is in the emissions inventory and absent from the energy one. State plainly that Berkeley's energy total is incomplete and that the size of the gap cannot be established from this data. Do NOT present Berkeley's energy figures as an efficiency achievement, and do NOT repeat any of this in Cork's or TU Dublin's report — neither shows the mismatch. GRI 302-3 energy intensity, normalised per unit of floor area.
302-4 Reduction of energy consumption	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
302-5 Reductions in energy requirements of products and services	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 303: Water and Effluents 2018

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
303-1 Interactions with water as a shared resource	Reported	Level of physical water quantity risk for the institution's main campus: Low-medium Does the institution harvest rainwater on-site for storage and use?: Yes	A risk grade is not the description GRI 303-1 asks for: it says nothing about how water is withdrawn, consumed or discharged, how the impacts were identified, or how the institution works with stakeholders on shared water resources. It also covers the main campus only, where a multi-campus institution has several. Only one of the three institutions quantifies the volume harvested; the other two answer the yes/no only.
303-2 Management of water discharge-related impacts	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
303-3 Water withdrawal	Reported	Total water withdrawal: 54,153 Cubic meters Potable water from off-site sources: 54,153 Cubic meters Potable water from on-site sources: 0 Cubic meters	GRI 303-3 requires a breakdown by source AND a separate figure for areas with water stress. STARS collects neither, so 303-3 cannot be fully satisfied from STARS alone. UNITS: GRI 303-3 requires megaliters and STARS reports cubic meters — a thousandfold difference, so the two are never interchangeable. The same mismatch affects GRI 302-1, which wants joules where STARS reports megawatt-hours. △ DO NOT CONVERT IN PROSE, AND DO NOT STATE THE CONVERSION FACTOR. A conversion factor is a figure, and no figure may enter the narrative that the code did not substitute. Report the STARS value in its own units and name the unit difference in words; if a figure in GRI's units is ever required, derive it in code from the verified value. Maps to the specific GRI 303-3-a-v category 'Third-party water'. It is the ONLY withdrawal source these universities have — on-site abstraction is zero for all three — so this equals the total. Zero for all three institutions, which is itself the finding: none of them abstracts its own water. Retained so the GRI 303-3 source breakdown is complete rather than silent.
303-4 Water discharge	Not reported	Assessed: the nearest STARS field (OP-3 / Annual volume of water recovered and/or returned) was reviewed and rejected as an answer to this disclosure.	GRI 303-4 requires discharge by destination, freshwater/other water split, and treatment level. STARS captures none of that. Weak mapping - verify before use.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
303-5 Water consumption	Not reported	Assessed: the nearest STARS field (OP-3 / Annual potable water use) was reviewed and rejected as an answer to this disclosure.	DEFINITIONS DIFFER. GRI 303-5 water consumption = withdrawal minus discharge. STARS 'annual potable water use' is potable supply only and is not computed that way. Do not present this as GRI 303-5 without recomputing.

GRI 305: Emissions 2016

305-1 Direct (Scope 1) GHG emissions	Reported	Annual scope 1 GHG emissions: 6,215.78 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 1 GHG emissions from stationary combustion: 5,517 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 1 GHG emissions from mobile combustion: 62.78 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 1 GHG fugitive emissions: 636 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent GHG emissions from biogenic sources: 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Baseline year for scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 2017 Baseline scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 19,460 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Narrative outlining when and why the GHG emissions baseline was adopted: This is the emissions baseline that has been set by the government of Ireland for all p... Description of the methodology or calculator used to conduct the scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions inventory: Calculated by our contracted supplier Sustineo to GHG Protocol standards and ISO 14064-...	GRI 305-1 additionally requires biogenic CO2 to be reported separately from the gross figure. GRI asks for biogenic CO2 specifically; the STARS field is CO2-equivalent and may not be the same boundary. STARS reports ONE baseline covering scope 1 and scope 2 together. GRI states the base year separately for 305-1 and 305-2, so this figure serves both jointly and neither alone — it cannot be split. So it answers 305-1-d-ii and 305-2-d-ii only as a combined total, which is weaker than either disclosure asks for on its own. GRI additionally requires the source of the emission factors and GWP rates (305-1-e) and the consolidation approach (305-1-f); STARS collects neither. Not populated by this institution: OP-6 / Scope 1 GHG process emissions.
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Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
305-2 Energy indirect (Scope 2) GHG emissions	Reported	Annual scope 2 GHG emissions: 8,144 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 2 GHG emissions from off-site sources of electricity (market-based): 8,144 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 2 GHG emissions from off-site sources of electricity (location-based): 8,144 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 2 GHG emissions from off-site sources of heating and cooling: 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Baseline year for scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 2017 Baseline scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 19,460 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Narrative outlining when and why the GHG emissions baseline was adopted: This is the emissions baseline that has been set by the government of Ireland for all p... Description of the methodology or calculator used to conduct the scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions inventory: Calculated by our contracted supplier Sustineo to GHG Protocol standards and ISO 14064-...	GRI 305-2 requires location-based and, where available, market-based figures reported separately. Do not present a single scope 2 number without saying which method. STARS reports ONE baseline covering scope 1 and scope 2 together. GRI states the base year separately for 305-1 and 305-2, so this figure serves both jointly and neither alone — it cannot be split. So it answers 305-1-d-ii and 305-2-d-ii only as a combined total, which is weaker than either disclosure asks for on its own. GRI additionally requires the source of the emission factors and GWP rates (305-2-e) and the consolidation approach (305-2-f); STARS collects neither.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
305-3 Other indirect (Scope 3) GHG emissions	Reported	Scope 3 GHG emissions from business travel: 3,565 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 3 GHG emissions from commuting: 20,991 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 3 GHG emissions from purchased goods and services: 1,572 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 3 GHG emissions from capital goods: 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Scope 3 GHG emissions from fuel- and energy-related activities not included in scope 1 or scope 2: 3,318 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent	Not populated by this institution: OP-6 / Scope 3 GHG emissions from waste generated in operations.
305-4 GHG emissions intensity	Reported	Annual scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions per person: 557.01 Kilograms of CO2 equivalent Annual scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions per unit of floor area: 50.86 Kilograms per square meter	GRI 305-4 emissions intensity, normalised per person. [△] THE THREE SUBMISSIONS DO NOT SHARE A REPORTING BOUNDARY, so figures normalised per person or per unit of area are not like-for-like across them. Cork's boundary narrative excludes its subsidiary companies by name — Campus Accommodation, the Mardyke Arena, the Student Centre and the Irish Management Institute — and excludes rented multi-tenant buildings; Berkeley's covers everything under its operational control, residences and grounds included. This biases Cork's per-person figures DOWNWARD: students living in Campus Accommodation still count in its full-time-equivalent denominator while their residential consumption falls outside the numerator. Per-area figures are less affected, since the excluded buildings are missing from both halves. Where such a figure is cited comparatively, name the boundary difference; never present the gap as performance alone. GRI 305-4 emissions intensity, normalised per unit of floor area.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
305-5 Reduction of GHG emissions	Reported	Percentage reduction in scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions from baseline: 26.21 Baseline scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 19,460 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Baseline year for scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 2017 Narrative outlining when and why the GHG emissions baseline was adopted: This is the emissions baseline that has been set by the government of Ireland for all p... Adjusted net scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions: 14,359.78 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent Third party certified carbon offsets: 0 Metric tons of CO2 equivalent	GRI 305-5 asks for reductions as an ABSOLUTE quantity in metric tons CO2e; STARS gives a percentage. △ THAT PERCENTAGE IS NET OF PURCHASED OFFSETS. STARS computes it from Adjusted net scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions, not from the gross total printed alongside it, so the two do not reconcile wherever an institution holds offsets: Berkeley's reduction is 6.54% gross and 9.83% net, a third of the headline figure being bought rather than achieved. Cork and TU Dublin agree on both bases only because their offsets are zero. Deriving the absolute reduction as baseline minus current gives the GROSS figure — correct, but not the number STARS prints. Say which basis is being quoted, and report the offsets separately as GRI 305-5's compilation requirement 2.9.5 demands. Derive it; do not present the baseline itself as a reduction. The subtraction is only valid because both figures cover the same combined scope 1 + 2 boundary. STARS reports ONE baseline covering scope 1 and scope 2 together. GRI states the base year separately for 305-1 and 305-2, so this figure serves both jointly and neither alone — it cannot be split. GRI 305-5-b (gases included) and 305-5-d (which scopes the reductions occurred in) remain unanswered — STARS reports the reduction against the combined scope 1 + 2 total without attributing it to either. GROSS AND NET DIVERGE WHERE OFFSETS EXIST. Berkeley's reduction is 6.54% gross and 9.83% net; Cork's and TU Dublin's are identical either way because they hold no offsets. State which basis is being quoted. Berkeley holds 4,858 tCO2e of third-party certified offsets, which is the entire difference between its gross and adjusted-net reduction — about a third of the headline figure. STARS also reports a Net carbon sinks field which is CAPPED and does NOT equal the deduction actually applied, so do not use it to reconcile the two percentages.
305-6 Emissions of ozone-depleting substances (ODS)	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS 3.0 collects no ODS data at any credit. Cannot be reported from this dataset.
305-7 Nitrogen oxides (NOx), sulfur oxides (SOx), and other significant air emissions	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS 3.0 collects no criteria-air-pollutant data. Cannot be reported from this dataset.

GRI 306: Waste 2020

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
306-1 Waste generation and significant waste-related impacts	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
306-2 Management of significant waste-related impacts	Reported	Does the institution have a surplus program through which institution-owned items that are no longer needed are stored for eventual sale, donation, or reuse?: Yes Does the institution have or participate in a reuse program through which employees and/or students can donate personal items for redistribution?: Yes Has the institution eliminated the on-site use of at least one form of single-use disposable plastic?: Yes Does the institution have a hazardous waste management program or protocol that includes measures to minimize or reduce the use of hazardous materials?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's composting program: Compostable lunchboxes are accepted in the University's food waste bins. Does the institution have sufficient data on construction and demolition waste to pursue this indicator?: Yes	GRI 306-3 additionally requires hazardous waste to be quantified separately from non-hazardous. STARS quantifies only non-hazardous and construction-and-demolition waste, so the tonnage is unavailable. It states data sufficiency as a yes/no rather than describing the collection process, and covers construction and demolition waste only.

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
306-3 Waste generated	Reported	Annual non-hazardous waste generated: 520 Metric tons Annual construction and demolition waste generated: 6,914.08 Metric tons	NOT EQUIVALENT - a subset. GRI 306-3-a is TOTAL waste generated including hazardous, broken down by composition. STARS reports non-hazardous only and collects no hazardous tonnage at any credit, so 306-3 cannot be fully satisfied. Do not present non-hazardous waste as the organisation's total waste. (Contrast the 306-4 and 306-5 rows, which are component : GRI has explicit non-hazardous lines at 306-4-c and 306-5-c for the STARS figures to answer, whereas 306-3 has no non-hazardous sub-requirement at all — which is why this row is weaker than those two, not equal to them.)
306-4 Waste diverted from disposal	Reported	Total non-hazardous waste diverted from disposal: 242 Metric tons Non-hazardous waste recycled: 183 Metric tons Non-hazardous waste composted: 59 Metric tons Non-hazardous waste prepared for reuse: 0 Metric tons Total construction and demolition waste diverted from disposal: 6,837.95 Metric tons Construction and demolition waste recycled: 5,675.22 Metric tons Construction and demolition waste prepared for reuse: 1,162.73 Metric tons	Exact scope match on GRI 306-4-c, including its split by recovery operation (reuse / recycling / other) from the rows below. GRI 306-4-d additionally wants each operation split on-site vs off-site, which STARS does not collect. NOT THE WHOLE DISCLOSURE: the hazardous half is absent. STARS weighs no hazardous waste anywhere — OP-11 records only whether a hazardous-waste programme exists and describes it in prose. For a research university that is a materially significant stream going unreported, and it is a finding about STARS rather than about these institutions. Reuse is a higher-value recovery route than recycling under the waste hierarchy, so omitting it understates the quality of diversion as well as the arithmetic. Cork recovers 1,162.73 of 6,837.95 tonnes this way.
306-5 Waste directed to disposal	Reported	Non-hazardous waste disposed of to a landfill or incinerator: 278 Metric tons Construction and demolition waste disposed of to a landfill or incinerator: 76.13 Metric tons	WEAKER THAN THE 306-4 EQUIVALENT: GRI 306-5-c also requires the total split across four disposal operations — incineration with energy recovery, incineration without, landfilling, other — and STARS merges landfill and incineration into a single figure. The waste-to-energy percentage field would separate incineration with recovery, but only two of the three institutions report it, so the split cannot be derived consistently. NOT THE WHOLE DISCLOSURE: the hazardous half is absent. STARS weighs no hazardous waste anywhere — OP-11 records only whether a hazardous-waste programme exists and describes it in prose. For a research university that is a materially significant stream going unreported, and it is a finding about STARS rather than about these institutions.

GRI 308: Supplier Environmental Assessment 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
308-1 New suppliers that were screened using environmental criteria	Partially reported	Does the institution's supplier code of conduct include one or more expectations in regard to environmental impact that exceed or are additional to regulatory compliance?: No Percentage of bid solicitations that identify supplier sustainability considerations: 21	GRI 308-1 requires a percentage of new suppliers actually screened. STARS reports the existence of the criteria, not their application to any supplier, so no percentage can be derived. The denominator is bid solicitations, not new suppliers, and one solicitation may attract many suppliers or none. 'Sustainability considerations' is also broader than the environmental criteria GRI 308-1 specifies. The figure is 0 percent at TU Dublin, so a low value here should not be read as a screening failure without checking the product-specification field alongside it.
308-2 Negative environmental impacts in the supply chain and actions taken	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

GRI 401: Employment 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
401-1 New employee hires and employee turnover	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS 3.0 collects no hiring or turnover figures.
401-2 Benefits provided to full-time employees that are not provided to temporary or part-time employees	Partially reported	Percentage of employees eligible for paid all-gender family/medical leave: 100	GRI 401-2 turns on the contrast between full-time employees and temporary or part-time employees, and asks for the benefits by significant location of operation. STARS gives a single institution-wide eligibility rate with no employment-type split, so the comparison the disclosure exists to make cannot be drawn.
401-3 Parental leave	Partially reported	Number of weeks of paid maternity leave: 26 Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the maternity leave options available to employees: Under the maternity legislation all women are entitled to 42 weeks maternity leave. Pay...	GRI 401-3 requires headcounts by gender: employees entitled to parental leave, those who took it, those who returned, those still employed twelve months later, and the resulting return-to-work and retention rates. STARS reports none of these — it reports the policy, not its uptake. 'Maternity' is also narrower than GRI's 'parental'. Descriptive only; supplies none of the headcounts or rates GRI 401-3 requires.

GRI 403: Occupational Health and Safety 2018

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
403-1 Occupational health and safety management system	Partially reported	Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's workplace health and safety committees: The University has a Safety Representative Forum. The aim of the Forum is to enhance th...	STARS never asks the 403-1 question, so an answer only appears where the institution volunteered it. Nothing records whether the system exists because of a legal requirement, which standard it follows, or which workers, activities and workplaces it covers — that is 403-1-b, and it is absent.
403-2 Hazard identification, risk assessment, and incident investigation	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
403-3 Occupational health services	Partially reported	Does the institution make physical health services available to employees?: Yes	General employee health services are not occupational health services: GRI 403-3 is about the function that identifies and eliminates workplace hazards, and about how worker health data is kept confidential. STARS asks about neither.
403-4 Worker participation, consultation, and communication on occupational health and safety	Reported	Does the institution have an institution-wide health and safety committee or network of committees that brings together workers and management in the development and review of workplace health and safety policies and procedures?: Yes Narrative and/or website URL providing an overview of the institution's workplace health and safety committees: The University has a Safety Representative Forum. The aim of the Forum is to enhance th...	GRI 403-4-b further requires the committee's responsibilities, meeting frequency, decision-making authority, and whether any workers are unrepresented. STARS records existence only. Depth varies by institution; meeting frequency and decision-making authority are not consistently stated.
403-5 Worker training on occupational health and safety	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
403-6 Promotion of worker health	Reported	Does the institution make physical health services available to employees?: Yes Does the institution make behavioral health services available to employees?: Yes Does the institution make free or reduced cost fitness activities available to employees?: Yes Does the institution prohibit smoking and tobacco use across the entire campus?: No Does the institution make contemplative and/or spiritual activities available to employees?: Yes	GRI 403-6-a also requires the scope of access provided; STARS records availability as a yes/no, with the scope left to the narrative. A prohibition is a control rather than a voluntary promotion service; STARS also records the weaker variants (indoor-only, restricted outdoor smoking) in separate fields.
403-7 Prevention and mitigation of occupational health and safety impacts directly linked by business relationships	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
403-8 Workers covered by an occupational health and safety management system	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	
403-9 Work-related injuries	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	PA-11 (Health, Safety and Wellbeing) contains no injury figures - its only numeric fields are STARS scoring artefacts. Cannot be reported.
403-10 Work-related ill health	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	PA-11 contains no ill-health figures. Cannot be reported.

GRI 405: Diversity and Equal Opportunity 2016

Disclosure	Status	Value / reason	Notes
405-1 Diversity of governance bodies and employees	Reported	Ethnic diversity index for executive staff: 0 Percentage of executive staff that identify as women or other marginalized gender identities: 47 Percentage of regular/permanent academic staff that identify as women or other marginalized gender identities: 49 Percentage of regular/permanent non-academic staff that identify as women or other marginalized gender identities: 63 Ethnic diversity index for academic staff: 0.44 Ethnic diversity index for non-academic staff: 0.34	This is a diversity INDEX (a single 0-1 concentration score), not the percentage breakdown GRI 405-1-b asks for. It shows how mixed the group is, not what share each group holds. No STARS credit collects employee age at all, so GRI 405-1's age-group split (under 30 / 30-50 / over 50) is unanswerable for every employee category. 405-1-a is still not answered: STARS PA-3 records which constituencies are represented on the highest decision-making body, never what percentage of that body they make up. DATA QUALITY: TU Dublin's value is the string '0 Revised on Nov. 24, 2025' — annotation text concatenated onto the figure — so the field is typed <code>text</code>, not <code>number</code>, and will not parse. Cork and Berkeley are clean. STARS reports one combined figure for 'women or other marginalized gender identities' rather than a percentage per gender, so the split GRI asks for is two buckets, not three.
405-2 Ratio of basic salary and remuneration of women to men	Not reported	No STARS data exists for this disclosure.	STARS FIELDS: nothing. PA-13 covers living-wage coverage and wage floors, not a gender pay ratio — despite the credit being named 'Pay Equity'. BUT the evidence documents linked from STARS answers partially close this: UCC publishes V3EDIGenderPayGapReport2025.pdf and TU Dublin Gender-Pay-Gap-Report-2023-FINALv1.pdf, both stating a mean gender pay gap. Berkeley links no equivalent. NOT a substitute for 405-2: GRI wants the ratio of basic salary and remuneration of women to men PER EMPLOYEE CATEGORY and per significant location; these reports give one organisation-wide percentage. Reportable as context with the source named, for 2 of 3 institutions, and it must be read out of the PDF by a human — it is not in any structured field, so it cannot go through the Jinja2 number path.

Verifying this report

Every figure above is recorded in `report/output/index_provenance.csv` with the exact STARS credit and field it came from, so any number can be traced to a row of the source dataset without trusting the generator. `tests/test_content_index.py` re-derives them independently of the code that produced them.